



Week 2 Lab – Creating a Product Backlog in Jira

In this lab, we will be setting up a **product backlog** using Atlassian’s popular project management software, **Jira**.

In particular, we are going to create a new Jira workspace and set up your first Scrum space.

NB: you are **free to use other project management tools (or even Google Sheets)** in the IS212 project. This lab is simply to illustrate one popular example. 😊

Setting Up a Jira Account and Scrum Space

In the first step, we are going to create a new Jira workspace and scrum space. Note: Atlassian recently renamed Jira “projects” to “spaces”, so you may see either word in the interface. Make sure you create a Jira Space using the Scrum template, and not a separate “Atlassian Project” (a different, higher-level planning tool that Atlassian introduced under the same-sounding name).

Please follow the steps below:

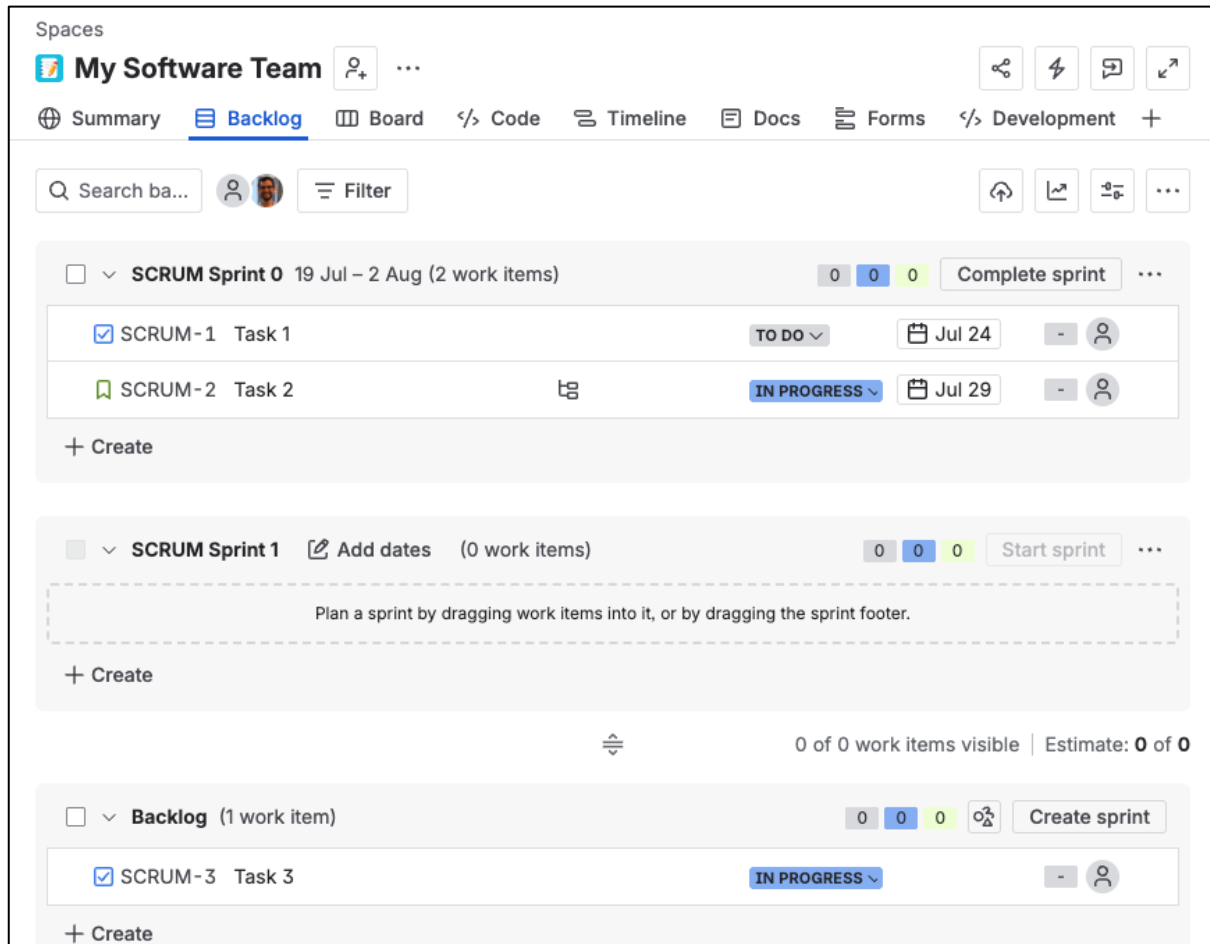
1. Go to: <https://www.atlassian.com/software/jira/pricing>
2. Select “Get it Now” under the Free (\$0) plan.
3. Either log in to your existing Atlassian/Jira account or create a new one. You can use Google SSO to connect it with your SMU email address.
4. Choose a URL for your Jira site, e.g. “yourusername-is212.atlassian.net”. Wait a minute or two for Jira to set everything up (don’t close your browser window).
5. You may be asked to click through some options. Under “Software Development”, select the scrum option. For the remaining options, just use the defaults.

At this point, your new Jira scrum space should be ready to experiment with.

Add User Stories to the Product Backlog

Upon your space's creation, you should be seeing the "Backlog" page. (If not, click on "Backlog" using the horizontal menu near the top of the page.)

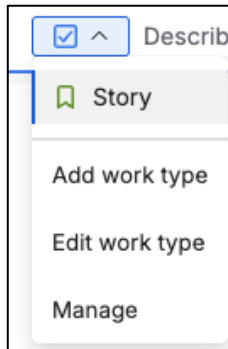
It should look something like this:



Note the **Backlog** box at the bottom of the page, which is where your space's Product Backlog is listed. Besides a pre-populated task, it is currently empty.

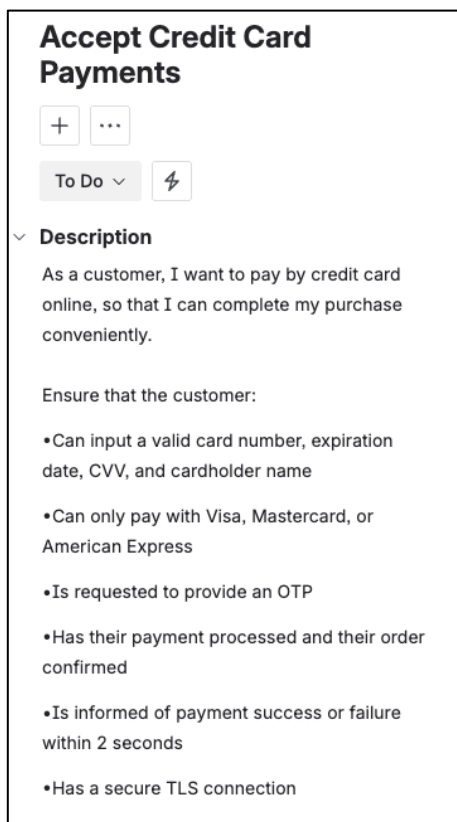
Let's start populating it with a user story.

1. To do so, click on **" + Create "**.
2. Select the "Story" work type from the dropdown menu:



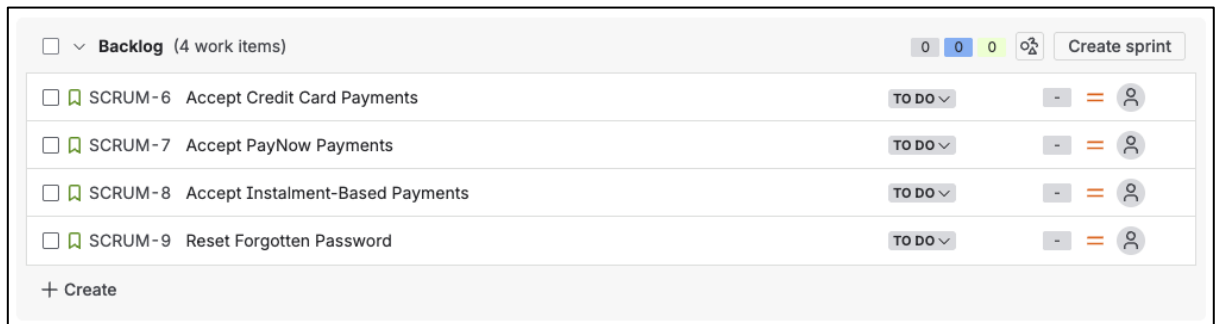
Important: “work item” is how Jira refers to product backlog items. Work types include user stories but also other backlog items such as bug fixes.

3. Replace “Describe what needs to be done” with a User Story Title. For example, “Accept Credit Card Payments”. After entering a title, press the enter key.
4. Click on the title of the newly created story, and a panel should open to the right-hand side of the screen.
5. Click on the (empty) description, and add the user story and acceptance criteria, e.g.



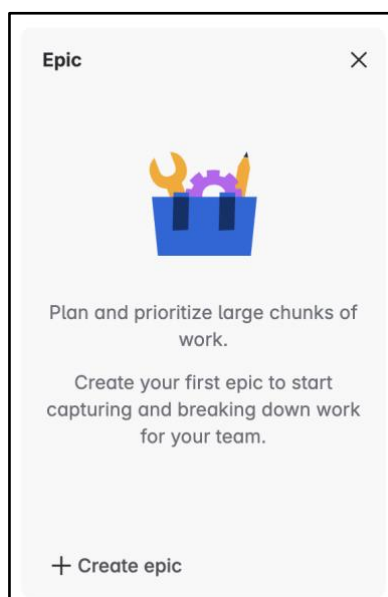
Don't forget to click “Save”! 😊

6. Return to the product backlog and create a few more user stories. For illustration, I'm adding additional stories about the checkout process, and another one for an unrelated part of the website (forgotten passwords). I also deleted the pre-populated work item that Jira inserted when creating the space.



7. Now that you have a few user stories in your product backlog, you can re-prioritise them by clicking-and-dragging more important stories to the top.
8. Note also that a few of the stories above are quite closely related (i.e. they concern payments). We can group them together with an “epic”.

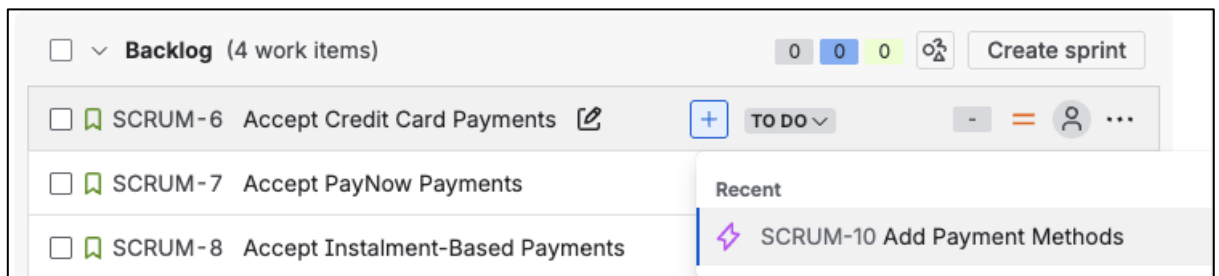
Press the “E” button **on your keyboard** and the Epic window should open:



Click on “+ Create epic”

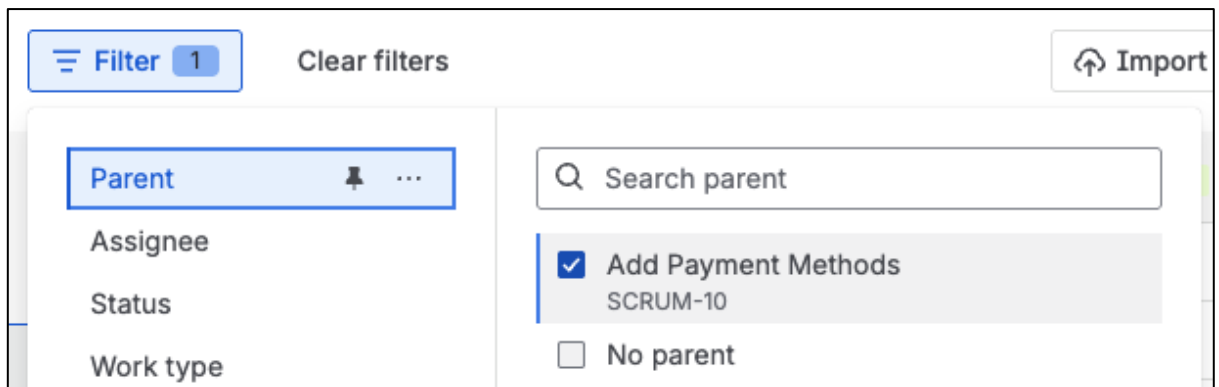
9. Enter “Add Payment Methods” as the epic’s title and press enter.
10. Return to your product backlog and associate the three payment-related stories to the overarching epic you created.

You can do this by hovering the mouse over each story, clicking the “+” or “+ Epic” button that appears, then selecting the epic:



11. Explore the rest of your Jira space to see the effect of using an epic.

See, for example, how you can filter stories in your backlog by epic:



That's all for now! More Jira to come in future labs. ✓